

Regulatory Affairs and Compliance

Science

May, 2026

Regulatory Affairs and Compliance (A09655)

Short Title:	Reg Affairs & Compliance	
Faculty	Science and Computing	
Department	Science	
Cluster	Quality, Regulatory and Compliance	
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Credits	5	Level: Advanced

Description of Module / Aims

This module will develop the student's competency in identifying, interpreting and applying the regulations and procedures involved in obtaining and maintaining marketing authorisations in European and worldwide markets, and procedures to ensure compliance to pharmaceutical legislation.

Programmes

QUAL - 0007	BSc (Hons) in Applied Biology with Quality Management (WD_SQMBI_B)	4 / 1 / M
SCIE - 0028	BSc (Hons) in Applied Chemistry with Quality Management (WD_SQMCH_B)	4 / 1 / M
SCIE - 0028	BSc (Hons) in Molecular Biology with Biopharmaceutical Science (WD_SMBIO_B)	4 / 7 / M
SCIE - 0028	BSc (Hons) in Pharmaceutical Science (WD_SPHSC_B)	4 / 7 / M

Indicative Content

- Introduction to regulatory agencies, national, EU and emerging markets, role of EDQM, CHMP
- Overview of the development of the regulations: EU directives and regulations including 2001/83/EEC, 726/2004, 2004/27/EC, 2004/24/EC, Falsified Medicines directive, clinical trial directive
- Role of the regulatory affairs professional in compliance and inspections in the pharmaceutical industry: compliance files/technical agreements
- Application procedures for marketing authorisations: national, centralised, de-centralised, mutual recognition
- Legal basis for applications and required documentation: common technical documents and its worldwide application, additional requirements for emerging markets
- Maintenance of marketing authorisations, renewals, variations
- Packaging and labelling requirements: braille QRD format blue box requirements, child resistant/adult-friendly requirements for certain medicines
- Pharmacovigilance: role of QPPV, PSMF, PSUR RMP

Learning Outcomes

On successful completion of this module, a student will be able to:

1. Determine the agencies operating within the global pharmaceutical sector and their role in the regulation of all aspects of the regulation for the pharmaceutical industry.
2. Appraise the importance of the role of the regulatory affairs professional and their link to operations functions within the industry from development phase, to ensure compliance at all stages.
3. Compare and contrast the possible routes to be followed to obtain a marketing authorisation in various sectors of the industry, and apply a suitable strategy to ensure a successful outcome.
4. Evaluate the relevant information necessary to be submitted to obtain and maintain authorisations in major markets and appropriate formatting of same.
5. Compile and apply the post-marketing obligations of the pharmaceutical manufacturer and MA holder in the on-going safety monitoring of pharmaceutical products.

Learning and Teaching Methods

- Lectures.
- Case studies.
- Review of pharmaceutical legislation framework.

Assessment Methods

	Weighing	Outcomes Assessed
Continuous Assessment	100%	
Case Studies	40%	3,4
Assignment	50%	5
Participation	10%	1,2

Assessment Criteria

<40%: No understanding of the basic concept of regulatory affairs and compliance. Unable to carry out critical thinking of subject area.

40%-49%: Is able to understand the regulatory affairs and compliance philosophies. May have some difficulty with critical thinking.

50%-59%: All the above in addition to evaluation of legislation and documentation. Correctly make suggestions for correct incorporation of new legislation and able to write quality documentation.

60%-69%: In addition to the above, good critical thinking and decision making abilities. Shows a high level of competence and efficiency in the subject area.

70%-100%: All previous to excellent level. Be able to describe and discuss regulatory affairs and compliance to the legislation pertaining to the pharmaceutical, food and healthcare industries.

Learning Modes

Learning Mode	F/T Hours	P/T Hours
Lecture	36	
Independent Learning	99	

Essential Material

- "www.ema.com; Notice to Applicants." <http://www.ema.europa.eu/ema/>
- "www.eudralex.com." http://ec.europa.eu/health/documents/eudralex/index_en.htm
- "www.fda.com." <http://www.fda.gov/Food/>
- "www.hpra.ie." <http://www.hpra.ie/>
- "www.mhra.gov.uk." <https://www.gov.uk/government/organisations/medicines-and-healthcare-products-regulatory-agency>